

New York Times, February, 2005

The Top Trends At CES 2005

CHARLES HEROLD OF *New York Times* says old arcade favourites are making a comeback. And how!

Imagine that every few years, the technology to broadcast television changed so radically that everything produced up until that time could no longer be shown. No more reruns of *The Mary Tyler Moore Show*, no more old *Marx Brothers* movies. You could only watch entertainment produced in the last two or three years. That is exactly what happens with computer games, where new technology is often incompatible with old games, turning great games into forgotten ones.

Happily, games are sometimes resurrected. Old arcade games like *Centipede* and *Pac-Man* have been released both for play on newer machines and in inexpensive devices you can plug into your television. Occasionally, something less ancient is resurrected, as when the original 'Resident Evil' was refurbished with slicker graphics for the GameCube. Recently, Sid Meier's 1987 game *Pirates!*, a collection of minigames representing various aspects of pirate life—battling ships, treasure hunting, trading goods, sword fighting—was completely remade for the modern PC.



biggest thrill has been the restoration of one of the oddest and most original adventure games ever made, Pulse Entertainment's 1996 game *Bad Mojo*, newly dubbed *Bad Mojo Redux*.

Bad Mojo begins as a scientist about to skip the country with his research money is inexplicably transformed into a cockroach who must make a perilous journey through his landlord's squalid apartment.

Mojo has a high gross-out factor, as you crawl over dead rats and half-eaten TV dinners trying to find a way around deadly hot-water pipes and roach traps. As you travel, you encounter slugs and water bugs that recite obscure passages of prose that contain clues to the game's puzzles.

As you wander through vast kitchens and under giant beds, you crawl over letters and photographs, learning about the landlord's tragic past. The game becomes increasingly surreal: photographs of eyes blink when you approach them, and visions hint that you are on some sort of spiritual journey.

The game's puzzles are generally straightforward, involving your limited ability to affect small objects, moving a cigarette butt or triggering an answering machine by walking on the Play button. There are a couple of more elaborate puzzles, but they tend to be based less on logic than on a spacy sort of synchronicity.

Read the full piece at www.snipurl.com/digit_games

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☒ Nooo! Leave the poor fishy alone!

A great visual, an even better punchline, but all we want to know is, "Did the poor fish survive the photo shoot?". Quick, someone call PETA!